

# User Research Summary: Solo Women Travel Safety

## Phase 1 Survey:

### Questions

1. *"What is your age group?"*
2. *"What is your gender?"*
3. *"How often do you travel alone?"*
4. *"What are your primary reasons for solo travel? (Select all that apply)"*
5. *"Which types of destinations do you usually visit?"*
6. *"What does the word 'safe' mean to you when you are travelling solo or in a group too?"*
7. *"Have you ever felt unsafe while traveling alone?"*
8. *"What safety concerns do you face while traveling alone? (Select all that apply)"*
9. *"What safety measures do you currently take while traveling solo? (Select all that apply)"*
10. *"Do you currently use any digital safety tools while traveling?"*
11. *"What features do you find most useful in a travel safety app?"*
12. *"How important is community support for your solo travel safety?"*
13. *"Would you trust real-time, user-generated safety ratings for locations?"*
14. *"Would you use a platform that connects solo travelers with verified local guides or buddy travelers?"*
15. *"What features would you like to see in an ideal travel safety platform?"*
16. *"How would you prefer to receive safety alerts while traveling?"*
17. *"Would you be willing to pay for a premium version of a travel safety app with advanced security features?"*
18. *"What improvements do you think should be made in existing travel safety solutions?"*

## Pain Points

- **Safety Concerns** – Survey Respondents worry about theft, scams, physical assault, and unsafe transport.
- **Negative Experiences:** Many Respondents have reported feeling unsafe during travelling.
- **Current Solution Limitations:** According to Respondents current apps lack robust verification making it less trustworthy.
- **Tool Adoption Issues:** Few Respondents don't use digital safety tools which indicates awareness gaps.
- **Complex Interfaces:** Increasing complexity in tools confuses the users and make them hesitate in fully relying on digital safety tools.

## User Needs

- **Reliable Alerts:** Travellers need real-time safety alerts including features like emergency SOS.
- **User-Friendly Tools:** Digital Tools needs to be simple to use and less complexity to learn.
- **Proper Verification:** Travellers need data coming from trusted sources and verify the safety information.
- **Effective Communication:** User needs clear methods to Receive safety alerts during travel.
- **Community Feedback:** System that maintains verified user-generated safety ratings and community support.

## Key Patterns

- **Demographics:** Majority of Respondents fall within age 18 to 25 range and above 40+ range.
- **Travel Frequency & Destinations:** Many solo travellers travel occasionally like around 2 – 4 times a year and some travelling rarely.
- **Destination Preferences:** Respondents need Urban Destinations and combination with domestic travel.
- **Primary Motivation:** Leisure or vacation is the leading reason for solo travel.
- **Important Features:** Features like real-time location sharing and emergency SOS are the most important.
- **Community Importance:** Community support and trust in user-generated ratings are extremely important in new locations.

## Further Exploration

- **Barriers to Digital Tool Adoption:** Need Investigation on why few solo travellers rarely use digital safety tools.
- **Location-Specific Features:** Need Exploration for demand in safety apps that have verified safety data.
- **Pricing Strategy:** Gathering more feedbacks from travellers willing to pay for premium safety features.
- **User Experience Improvements:** Gathering additional feedbacks on user interface and usability of apps to improve the solution.
- **Partnership with the locals:** Need Exploration for collaboration with local authorities to increase credibility.

## **Phase 2 Interview:**

### **Questions**

#### **Section 1: User Demographics & Travel Persona**

- *“What age group do you belong to?”*
- *“How frequently do you travel alone, and what factors influence this?”*
- *“What motivates you to travel solo?”*
- *“Can you describe the types of destinations you prefer to visit and why?”*

#### **Section 2: Safety Concerns & Challenges in Solo Travel**

- *“Can you share an experience where you felt unsafe while traveling alone?”*
- *“What are the most common safety concerns you consider before traveling alone?”*
- *“How do you assess the safety of accommodations and transport before choosing them?”*
- *“How do digital tools influence your sense of safety while traveling alone?”*

#### **Section 3: Digital Safety Solutions & Technology Preferences**

- *“What digital tools or safety apps do you currently use while traveling?”*
- *“What features do you currently find most useful in travel safety apps, and what additional features would you like to see?”*
- *“How do you evaluate the reliability of safety recommendations from AI or digital platforms?”*
- *“Would real-time, crowdsourced safety ratings influence your travel decisions? Why or why not?”*

#### **Section 4: Community & Social Support in Travel Safety**

- *“How do online communities and peer networks influence your travel safety decisions?”*
- *“How would having access to verified local guides impact your sense of safety and travel confidence?”*
- *“What are your thoughts on buddy systems for solo travellers? Have you used one before?”*

#### **Section 5: User Needs & Suggestions for Safety Solutions**

- *“If you could design an ideal solo travel safety tool, what features would it include?”*
- *“Based on your experiences, what improvements would you suggest for digital tools designed to enhance solo travel safety?”*
- *“What kind of support or solutions would help you feel more secure when traveling alone?”*

## Pain Points

- **Unreliable Safety Indicators:** Gaps in real time safety data
  - Driver taking to unfamiliar routes.
  - Delayed Assistance from digital apps.
  - Inconsistent user generated reviews.
- **Digital Tools Lack of Information:** Digital tools don't fully address all their needs which leads to confusion and having no proper solution.
- **Varied Alert Preferences:** Some users expressed a need for SMS alerts due to areas with network issues and some users prefer in-app notifications which creates uncertainty about which method would be the most effective during emergencies.
- **Lack of Verified Information:** While interviewing Users don't rely on AI Generated recommendations but only prefer verified reviews and community feedbacks.

## User Needs

- **Trusted and Verified Feedbacks:** Platforms needs to offer accurate, live safety updates, crowdsourced ratings and verified comments.
- **Real Time Alerts:** Alerts should show even during low-connectivity scenarios.
- **Integrated, User-Friendly Tools:** Travellers expects seamless safety solutions which combines features like live location sharing, emergency SOS and easy navigation in a single app.
- **Trusted Community Input:** User needs platforms that contain authentic feedbacks from fellow travellers ensuing safety ratings and recommendations are trustworthy.
- **Premium Feature Value:** Users are willing to purchase premium features if key features like offline support, direct emergency service integration and verified local authorities access are available at an affordable price.

## Key Patterns

- **Urban Travel:** As per the interview, travellers prefer urban destination with the combination of domestic travels.
- **Dependence on Reviews & Peer Feedback:** Interviewees heavily rely on reviews, ratings, and recommendations and also highlighted the importance of community generated insights.
- **Diverse Digital Tool Usage:** As per the interview, frequent solo travellers use variety of digital tools like transaction tools and location sharing and ride hailing apps but occasional travellers rely more on personal judgement and selected trusted platforms.
- **Skeptical towards AI:** Interviewees preferred human verified feedbacks over AI driven recommendations. AI shouldn't replace personal experiences.

## Expectations

- **Unified Safety Platform:** Users expect a single integrated app that has all features necessary like real-time safety alerts, verified reviews, and emergency services, eliminating the need to switch between multiple tools.
- **Reliability:** Users need robust system that can even work in challenging network conditions.
- **Verified Local Support:** Many Interviewees need features like verified reviews and authentic feedbacks as it will enhance their travel confidence.
- **Value-Added Premium Features:** If offered as a premium solution, advanced functionalities such as offline language translation and direct integration with emergency services and must be affordable then they are willing to pay for better safety.

## **Combined Summary of Phase 1 and Phase 2**

### **Phase 1 – Survey insights**

- Survey provided variety of insights about solo travellers in demographics, travel habits and safety concerns.
- Importance of real time alerts, reliance on user reviews, and preferences in digital tools.
- Major pain points were inconsistent safety information, lack of unified and reliable safety solutions

### **Phase 2 – In Depth Interview**

- Interviews had processed based questions which encouraged storytelling and detailed and proper responses
- Interviewees shared their personal experiences which highlighted specific challenges and gaps.
- Interviewees told how they used safety apps in detail and how would they prefer to receive alerts.
- They also expressed how much they preferred Human Verified feedbacks rather than AI Driven and needs unified and reliable safety problem.

# Insights & Trends Report

Both phases explored safety concerns, travel challenges, and digital safety solutions for solo travelers, especially women. While the survey provided quantitative trends, the interviews uncovered deeper emotional and experiential insights that were not as visible in the survey results.

- Phase 1 (Survey): 50 respondents (50% men, 50% women)
- Phase 2 (Interviews): 6 in-depth interviews, all women

Despite differences in research methods, several consistent themes emerged across both the survey and interviews:

1. Safety Concerns Dominate Travel Decisions
  - Fear of **harassment, stalking, theft, and scams** affects how travelers choose locations, accommodations, and transport.
  - Digital security concerns (e.g., cyber harassment, GPS tracking risks) were highlighted by many respondents.
  - **Public transport & cabs are often unreliable and unsafe**—travelers feel vulnerable in unfamiliar locations.
2. Lack of Reliable, Real-Time Safety Information
  - Existing solutions are often **generic and lack location-specific risk assessments**.
  - Users want **real-time, crowdsourced safety updates** and verified accommodation safety checks.
  - **SOS & emergency tools** need **faster response integration** with police and medical services.
3. Need for a Multi-Layered Safety Approach
  - Solo travelers rely on self-imposed safety measures (e.g., sharing location with family, avoiding night travel).
  - Current safety apps are underutilized due to lack of awareness or trust issues.
4. Desire for Verified Support Networks
  - Travelers want access to **trusted local guides, women-only spaces, and police-verified** services.
  - Community-driven safety ratings are valuable but require verification mechanisms to be truly effective.

## Key Differences in Findings: Phase 1 vs. Phase 2

| Category                  | Phase 1: Survey (50 Responses) – Broad Insights                                     | Phase 2: Interviews (6 Users) – Deep Insights                                                                           |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Safety Concerns           | Fear of harassment, unsafe transport, theft, scams.                                 | More detailed concerns like <b>stalking, unwanted attention, and digital safety threats</b> .                           |
| Use of Safety Tools       | Many travelers are <b>not using</b> safety apps regularly due to lack of awareness. | Users who do use safety tools often <b>find them ineffective or lacking real-time support</b> .                         |
| Emergency Response        | Slow SOS responses and limited real-time safety features.                           | More <b>nuanced frustrations with emergency services</b> , like <b>delayed police action or lack of local support</b> . |
| Accommodation Safety      | General distrust in host verification processes.                                    | More <b>specific concerns about women's safety in mixed-gender accommodations</b> .                                     |
| AI & Tech Integration     | Interest in AI-driven safety solutions.                                             | <b>Skepticism about AI-driven recommendations</b> ; prefer a <b>mix of human verification and AI insights</b> .         |
| Preferred Safety Features | Community-based solutions like <b>crowdsourced safety ratings</b> .                 | Preference for <b>verified local guides, women-only spaces, and direct government integrations</b> .                    |

It is evident that in the survey that was phase 1 of user research, people gave **shorter, more general responses**. They tend to report fewer personal experiences in surveys, focusing on what they logically prefer rather than what they've personally faced.

**Interviews** allowed participants to **share real incidents**, emotional responses, and **hidden fears that don't appear in survey**. It gave more **detailed descriptions of threats and safety behaviors**, including **how women adapt their travel habits** to stay safe.

## Gender Differences in Survey Responses (50% Men, 50% Women)- (Phase 1)

- **Women's Primary Concerns:**
  - **Personal safety, harassment, and physical security** were the top fears.
  - Higher demand for **women-only transport, trusted local networks, and verified accommodations**.
  - Less trust in **AI-driven solutions**—preferred **human verification & community support**.
- **Men's Primary Concerns:**
  - **Financial security (scams, fraud, theft)** ranked higher than personal safety.
  - More inclined towards **community-based safety ratings** rather than government integration.
  - Open to **AI-driven safety solutions** but saw them more as **"nice-to-have" features than necessities**.

## Impact of All-Women Interview Group (Phase 2)

- Since all interview participants were **women**, their experiences were **more emotionally charged** compared to survey responses.
- Several women shared **direct experiences of harassment, unsafe accommodations, and transport issues**, making personal safety a **top recurring theme**.
- They strongly **rejected over-reliance on AI** and emphasized the **need for faster emergency response, human-verified safety networks, and direct police coordination**.
- Women wanted **proactive alerts and verified safety networks** rather than just self-reporting tools.

After phase 1, we had come up with 4 persona types to classify our participant and that still prevails after our phase 2-

1. **Minimalist, Budget Conscious**
2. **Tech Enthusiast, Full Feature**
3. **Community & Information Driver**
4. **Cautious, Policing/Authority Integration**

## User Journey Maps

A User Journey Map (UJM) is a detailed visualization of a user's experience with a product, service, or system, broken down into different stages of interaction. It captures the user's actions, emotions, pain points, and touchpoints across the journey, helping to understand their needs, expectations, and frustrations at each step. We have made a generalised UJM of a solo female traveller irrespective of her user persona:

### User Journey Map - Solo Female Traveler Safety

| Stage               | Awareness                                        | Consideration                                          | Planning & Booking                                | Travel & Navigation                                | On-Trip Experience                             | Post Experience                             |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>User Actions</b> | Thinks about safety risks while planning travel. | Researches destinations, checks safety ratings & tips. | Books accommodation, transport, and safety tools. | Uses navigation apps, stays alert to surroundings. | Engages in activities while monitoring safety. | Shares experiences, safety feedback online. |

|                                |                                                 |                                                        |                                                     |                                              |                                                |                                          |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>Thoughts &amp; Feelings</b> | "Is this destination safe for solo travel?"     | "I need reliable safety info before making decisions." | "I hope my accommodation and transport are secure." | "Am I being followed? Is this cab safe?"     | "I want to enjoy, but I must stay cautious."   | "Should I warn others about this place?" |
| <b>Touch Points</b>            | Travel forums, social media, word-of-mouth.     | Safety apps, government advisories, reviews.           | Booking platforms, safety tool apps, GPS tracking.  | Maps, ride-sharing apps, emergency contacts. | Local guides, buddy systems, safety check-ins. | Travel groups, safety rating platforms.  |
| <b>Pain Points</b>             | Lack of reliable, real-time safety information. | AI safety ratings feel generic, not tailored.          | Booking sites lack verified security details.       | Unreliable public transport & cab safety.    | Safety concerns in public spaces, scams.       | No follow-up from safety platforms.      |

Furthermore, we tried creating separate UJMs for our four user personas. They will differ based on the persona's **specific concerns, behaviors, and expectations**.

1. Needs & Priorities → A budget traveler may focus more on affordable safety solutions, while a tech-savvy traveler may look for AI-driven safety tools.
2. Touchpoints & Digital Interactions → Some users rely on AI safety tools, while others trust community-driven insights.
3. Pain Points → A frequent traveler may face risks in unfamiliar international locations, while an occasional traveler might struggle with local safety concerns.
4. Safety Approaches → One persona may prefer verified accommodations & guides, while another relies on self-defense and emergency support.

## UJM - Minimalist, Budget-Conscious Traveler

(Focus: Affordable safety solutions, balancing cost and security.)

| Stage                          | Awareness                                                                          | Consideration                                                            | Booking & Preparation                                                         | During Travel                                                                               | Post-Experience                                                                          |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>User Actions</b>            | Thinks about budget travel, safety concerns, and solo trip feasibility.            | Searches for <b>affordable yet safe</b> stays & transport options.       | Books verified budget accommodation, checks forums for safety tips.           | Uses <b>public transport</b> , avoids risky areas, shares location with family.             | Shares experience, warns others about unsafe spots, looks for rewards or discounts.      |
| <b>Thoughts &amp; Feelings</b> | "I need to keep costs low but stay safe."                                          | "Are there any <b>cheap but reliable</b> hostels or homestays?"          | "I hope my stay and transport are <b>safe despite the low cost</b> ."         | "I should avoid unsafe areas. <b>Is public transport reliable at night?</b> "               | "Did I <b>save money without compromising safety?</b> "                                  |
| <b>Touch Points</b>            | Budget travel blogs, word-of-mouth, hostel reviews, forums.                        | Safety-rated budget stays, travel forums, ride-sharing options.          | Discount travel apps, local safety ratings, community recommendations.        | Public transport apps, <b>free safety tools (GPS, SOS features, travel buddy options)</b> . | Community forums, travel groups, review platforms.                                       |
| <b>Pain Points</b>             | Limited <b>affordable verified stays</b> , uncertainty in choosing safe transport. | Few <b>budget-friendly safety solutions</b> , unreliable safety ratings. | No easy way to <b>verify the safety of cheaper transport/accommodations</b> . | <b>Public transport delays, unresponsive emergency services.</b>                            | Lack of <b>post-travel engagement</b> , safety platforms not optimized for budget users. |

## UJM - Tech Enthusiast, Full-Feature User



(Focus: AI-powered, data-driven safety features.)

| Stage                          | Awareness                                                                                | Consideration                                                                      | Booking & Preparation                                                 | During Travel                                                                                    | Post-Experience                                                   |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>User Actions</b>            | Researches <b>AI-powered safety apps</b> , compares features.                            | Reads reviews on <b>AI safety tools, real-time tracking apps, and scam alerts.</b> | <b>Integrates travel with smart apps, sets up emergency contacts.</b> | Uses AI-based risk alerts, live location tracking, and scam detection tools.                     | <b>Gives feedback</b> on AI tool accuracy, suggests improvements. |
| <b>Thoughts &amp; Feelings</b> | "I want the best <b>technology-driven</b> safety solutions."                             | "Does this app provide <b>real-time risk assessment</b> ?"                         | "I hope the AI is <b>reliable and adapts to my needs.</b> "           | "Will AI-generated <b>safety alerts be accurate and timely?</b> "                                | "Did the AI tool <b>actually enhance my safety?</b> "             |
| <b>Touch Points</b>            | AI safety blogs, premium travel safety apps, user reviews.                               | App trials, feature comparison sites, cybersecurity insights.                      | <b>Predictive AI risk assessment tools</b> , automated safety checks. | <b>Real-time crime maps, AI-generated safe route suggestions, emergency response automation.</b> | App feedback loops, community forums, software updates.           |
| <b>Pain Points</b>             | <b>High cost</b> of premium AI safety tools, concerns about <b>privacy and tracking.</b> | AI-generated <b>recommendations are too generic</b> , lack local insights.         | <b>Complex setup</b> for AI-powered safety features.                  | <b>Over-reliance on AI</b> , inaccurate real-time updates.                                       | Limited AI adaptation based on <b>actual user experiences.</b>    |

## UJM - Community & Information Driver

(Focus: Community-driven safety, crowdsourced data.)

| Stage                          | Awareness                                                         | Consideration                                                           | Booking & Preparation                                                                   | During Travel                                                                   | Post-Experience                                                       |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>User Actions</b>            | Searches for <b>community-verified safety insights.</b>           | Participates in <b>female travel groups, social safety discussions.</b> | Books accommodations based on <b>community reviews.</b>                                 | Shares real-time safety updates, crowdsources risk alerts.                      | Reviews safety measures, contributes to safety forums.                |
| <b>Thoughts &amp; Feelings</b> | "I trust <b>real traveler experiences</b> over AI ratings."       | "Do others recommend this location for <b>solo female travelers?</b> "  | "I hope the <b>community-verified recommendations</b> are reliable."                    | "I should contribute to the community by <b>warning others about risks.</b> "   | "Did my experience help <b>future travelers make safer choices?</b> " |
| <b>Touch Points</b>            | Travel groups, social safety forums, peer-reviewed safety apps.   | Community ratings, <b>women-led travel platforms.</b>                   | <b>Verified local guides</b> , group safety features, forum discussions.                | <b>Live community alerts, shared safety experiences.</b>                        | Travel feedback groups, <b>safety trend discussions.</b>              |
| <b>Pain Points</b>             | <b>Limited availability of community-driven safety platforms.</b> | <b>Misinformation, fake reviews</b> , lack of <b>verified data.</b>     | <b>Few structured ways to share safety insights</b> , lack of <b>real-time updates.</b> | <b>Slow information updates</b> , community safety data isn't always real-time. | <b>Not enough engagement or post-travel safety impact tracking.</b>   |

## UJM - Cautious, Policing/Authority Integration

(Focus: Verified safety measures, law enforcement collaboration.)

| Stage               | Awareness                                                                                                     | Consideration                                                                  | Booking & Preparation                                                            | During Travel                                                                   | Post-Experience                                                          |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| User Actions        | Looks for <b>government-approved</b> travel safety guidelines.                                                | Checks police-verified accommodations, safe transport listings.                | Registers travel plans with embassies, downloads police-recommended safety apps. | Uses <b>official travel safety services</b> , reports incidents to authorities. | Files safety feedback with authorities, suggests improvements.           |
| Thoughts & Feelings | "I want <b>officially verified</b> safety measures."                                                          | "Is this stay or transport option <b>police-vetted</b> ?"                      | "I hope <b>law enforcement is accessible</b> if needed."                         | "How do I report <b>safety concerns quickly and effectively</b> ?"              | "Did authorities take <b>real action based on safety reports</b> ?"      |
| Touch Points        | Government travel advisories, embassy alerts, police-vetted safety apps.                                      | Verified accommodation listings, <b>local safety audits</b> .                  | <b>Embassy registration portals, law enforcement databases</b> .                 | <b>Emergency response centers, verified women-only transport</b> .              | Government safety forums, police report follow-ups.                      |
| Pain Points         | <b>Lack of government-verified safety solutions</b> , difficulty accessing real-time law enforcement updates. | <b>Limited coordination between law enforcement and digital safety tools</b> . | <b>Emergency services are slow or unresponsive</b> in many locations.            | <b>Difficulty in quickly reporting</b> or escalating safety incidents.          | <b>Lack of response from authorities</b> , safety reports often ignored. |

Contribution- Sajja & Himanshu

# Feature Recommendations Report

In this report, we will propose actionable recommendations that address user pain points and enhance solo traveler safety, particularly for women, by integrating user-centric digital features.

| Pain Points                                    | User Expectations/Needs                                 | Solution / Recommendation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Safety Concerns</b>                         | Quick emergency response and reliable safety measures.  | - <b>Smart SOS Button:</b> One-touch emergency support with live tracking. - <b>Verified Transport &amp; Stay:</b> Police-verified accommodations and women-only transport. - <b>AI Route Safety:</b> AI-powered route planning to avoid unsafe areas.                                  |
| <b>Lack of Reliable Safety Information</b>     | Trustworthy, real-time safety insights.                 | - <b>Crowdsourced Safety Ratings:</b> User-reported safety scores for locations. - <b>AI Risk Alerts:</b> Predictive analysis for potential safety threats. - <b>Anonymous Incident Reporting:</b> Enables users to report safety concerns discreetly.                                  |
| <b>Social &amp; Psychological Discomfort</b>   | Support networks and trusted local connections.         | - <b>Local Travel Buddy Matching:</b> Connects solo travelers with vetted companions. - <b>Women-Only Guides &amp; Groups:</b> Verified female guides for safer exploration. - <b>AI-Personalized Safe Itineraries:</b> Suggests secure routes and locations based on user preferences. |
| <b>Emergency Services Are Slow/Inefficient</b> | Faster and more efficient emergency response.           | - <b>Instant SOS Alerts:</b> Direct integration with local authorities and verified responders. - <b>Real-Time Location Sharing:</b> Auto-alerts contacts when entering high-risk zones.                                                                                                |
| <b>Digital &amp; Cybersecurity Risks</b>       | Protection from online scams, tracking, and harassment. | - <b>Encrypted Location Sharing:</b> Keeps personal data private while ensuring safety. - <b>AI Scam Detection:</b> Identifies fraudulent bookings and fake reviews. -                                                                                                                  |

|  |                                                                 |
|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | <b>Safe Browsing Mode:</b> Prevents tracking and cyber threats. |
|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------|

Some additional features that can be implemented:

- **Women-Only Accommodation & Transport Listings** – Verified safety ratings by users.
- **Verified Travel Companion Feature** – Matches solo travelers with trusted co-travelers.
- **Multilingual Safety Alerts** – Automatic translations for local emergency updates
- **Offline Mode for Safety Features** – SOS, safety guides, and maps available without the internet.

Certain features can be implemented to enhance the overall experience of the user-

- **Custom Safety Profiles** – Users can set preferences (e.g., minimal alerts, high-security mode).
- **AI-Based Personalized Recommendations** – Suggests best safety features based on travel habits.
- **Privacy-Focused Location Sharing** – Users control who sees their location and for how long.
- **Gamified Safety Awareness** – Reward system for sharing safety reports or checking in.
- **Minimalist UI for Quick Actions** – Reduces cognitive load in high-stress moments.

## **Job To Be Done Framework**

For our HMW statement, we will be using the **Jobs-To-Be-Done (JTBD) framework** because-

1. More user centric approach- JTBD focuses on WHY travelers need safety solutions and what jobs they are trying to accomplish.
2. Aligns With Real-World Travel Scenarios- Solo travelers don't just want less harassment; they want to explore freely with peace of mind. JTBD helps define what users actually want to achieve rather than just fixing complaints.

3. Safety isn't a single pain point but a continuous need during travel (from planning to navigation to emergency response). JTBD helps map out the traveler's journey and identify gaps in safety at each stage.

## 1. Pre-Travel Planning & Risk Assessment

| JTBD Statement                                                                                                                  | Pain Points                                                                              | User Needs/Gains                                                                     | Feature Recommendation                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When I plan a trip, I want to check safety ratings of different areas so that I can choose safer locations to stay and explore. | Lack of reliable, location-specific safety data; difficulty identifying high-risk areas. | Trustworthy, real-time safety ratings based on community insights and official data. | <b>AI-powered safety heatmaps &amp; crowdsourced location safety ratings.</b> |
| When I book an accommodation, I want verified safety reviews so that I can trust my stay will be secure.                        | Fear of unsafe accommodations, lack of verified safety info.                             | Police-verified stays & community-based safety reviews.                              | <b>"Verified Safe Stay" label for accommodations.</b>                         |
| When I prepare for my trip, I want safety tips based on my destination so that I feel prepared for local risks.                 | Unawareness of local safety concerns, scams, or cultural risks.                          | Personalized travel safety briefings.                                                | <b>AI-driven travel safety insights before departure.</b>                     |

## 2. Safe Navigation & Transit

| JTBD Statement                                                                                                           | Pain Points                                                             | User Needs/Gains                                           | Feature Recommendation                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| When I take a taxi alone, I want real-time trip monitoring so that someone is aware of my route in case of an emergency. | Unreliable cab services, risk of unsafe routes, lack of accountability. | Auto-tracking, trusted contacts alerted if route deviates. | <b>Live trip tracking with emergency deviation alerts.</b> |
| When I walk in an unknown area, I want route                                                                             | Unsafe public spaces, walking alone at night,                           | AI-powered navigation that prioritizes safety.             | <b>Smart route planning that avoids high-risk areas.</b>   |

|                                                                                                                     |                                                           |                                      |                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| recommendations based on safety so that I avoid dangerous streets.                                                  | unfamiliarity with surroundings.                          |                                      |                                                                        |
| When I feel unsafe in transit, I want quick access to emergency help so that I can immediately call for assistance. | Slow emergency response, difficulty reaching authorities. | Fast and reliable emergency support. | <b>One-touch SOS button integrated with police/emergency services.</b> |

### 3. Real-Time Safety & Emergency Support

| JTBD Statement                                                                                                        | Pain Points                                                       | User Needs/Gains                              | Feature Recommendation                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When I enter a new place, I want real-time alerts about unsafe areas so that I can make informed decisions.           | No instant updates on potential safety risks.                     | Live alerts about changing safety conditions. | <b>Push notifications for nearby safety risks.</b>                  |
| When I feel unsafe, I want an easy way to notify my trusted contacts so that I know someone is aware of my situation. | No quick way to notify family or friends.                         | Auto-alert system for emergencies.            | <b>Periodic safety check-ins &amp; distress alerts.</b>             |
| When I face an emergency, I want a way to contact police quickly so that I don't lose time seeking help.              | Slow emergency response, difficulty navigating emergency numbers. | Instant contact with authorities.             | <b>Direct emergency call integration with local police/hotline.</b> |

### 4. Community-Based Safety & Support

| JTBD Statement | Pain Points | User Needs/Gains | Feature Recommendation |
|----------------|-------------|------------------|------------------------|
|----------------|-------------|------------------|------------------------|

|                                                                                                   |                                                         |                                 |                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| When I travel alone, I want to connect with other verified travelers so that I feel more secure.  | Feeling isolated, lacking support network.              | Verified community connections. | <b>Trusted travel buddy or local female guide feature.</b> |
| When I experience a safety issue, I want to report it anonymously so that others can be warned.   | Lack of real-time incident reporting.                   | User-driven safety insights.    | <b>Anonymous incident reporting system.</b>                |
| When I visit a new place, I want to read community safety reviews so that I can plan accordingly. | No way to access real experiences from other travelers. | Peer-verified safety insights.  | <b>User-generated safety ratings &amp; reviews.</b>        |

## 5. Digital & Cyber Safety

| <b>JTBD Statement</b>                                                                                  | <b>Pain Points</b>                      | <b>User Needs/Gains</b>                            | <b>Feature Recommendation</b>                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| When I use online travel services, I want to protect my personal data so that I avoid digital threats. | Cyber harassment, identity theft risks. | Strong privacy features.                           | <b>Built-in VPN or secure browsing in the app.</b> |
| When I share my location, I want control over who can see it so that I feel safe.                      | Fear of digital tracking & data misuse. | Secure, customizable location sharing.             | <b>End-to-end encrypted location sharing.</b>      |
| When I join a travel community, I want verification so that I interact with trusted users.             | Risk of interacting with scammers.      | Verified profiles & trusted community connections. | <b>User verification &amp; rating system.</b>      |

## Conclusion

The Jobs-To-Be-Done (JTBD) framework effectively aligns the real-world safety concerns of solo travelers—especially women—with practical, user-driven solutions. By identifying their core jobs, pain points, and expected gains,

we ensure that every recommended feature directly addresses security, trust, and usability.

This structured approach provides a seamless safety experience, from trip planning to real-time navigation, emergency support, and digital security. It also enhances community engagement by integrating crowdsourced insights and verified networks.

By implementing these features, the product will not only enhance user efficiency and effectiveness but also build a safety ecosystem that empowers travelers with information, support, and immediate action when needed. This approach will lead to higher adoption, increased trust, and a genuinely safer travel experience for solo travelers worldwide.

Contribution- Sajja & Himanshu